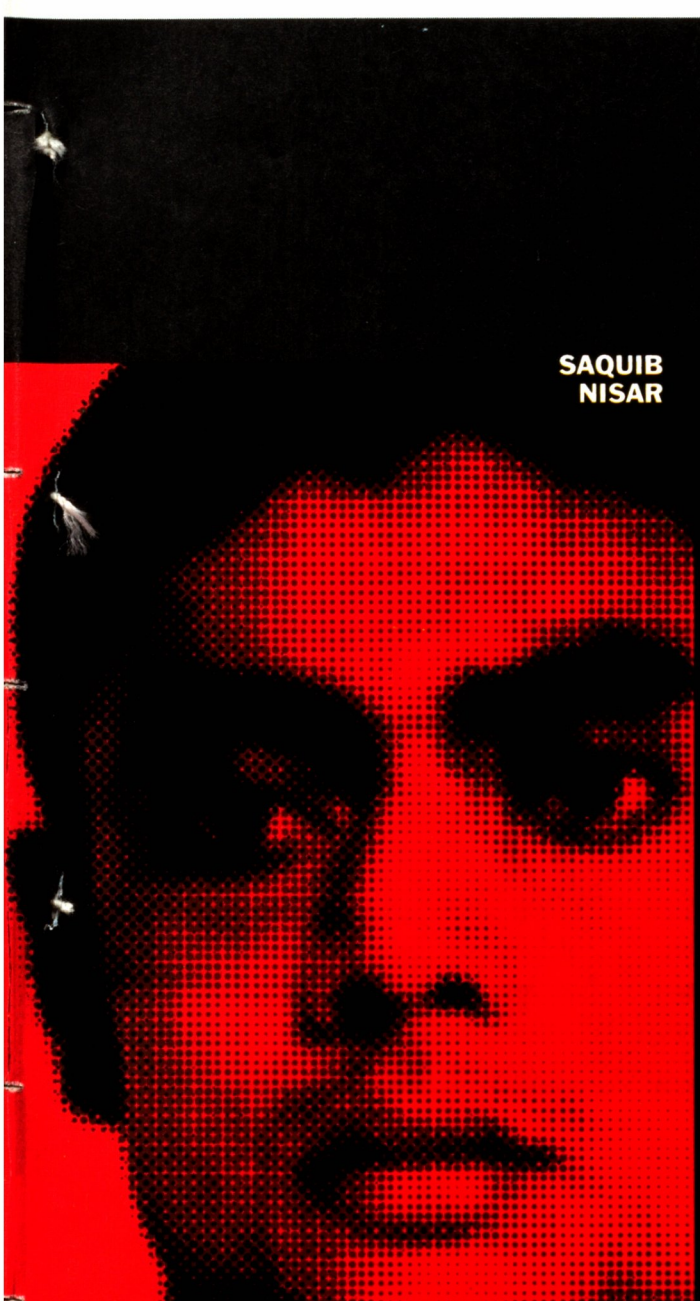




**SAQUIB
NISAR**

On the evening of Saturday, September 13, a series of bomb blasts ripped through the capital. The blasts took place in the most popular and crowded shopping centres, killing 25 and injuring 200. Six days later, the Delhi Police conducted a raid on a flat in Zakir Nagar, an area where many students of nearby Jamia Millia Islamia stay. Two persons inside the flat were killed as was a highly decorated officer who led the raid. One occupant, Mohammed Saif, was arrested. The police announced that one of those killed was Atif, the mastermind behind the blasts. Two members of the terror module managed to escape.

The caretaker of the Zakir Nagar flat, Abdul Rehman, was the key to three more arrests on September 21, three educated young men: Zia-ur Rehman, Saquib Nisar and Mohammed Shakeel. The three were charged with being a major operational arm of the Indian Mujahideen and with planting bombs, not just in Delhi but in Ahmedabad and Jaipur as well, sites of earlier serial bombings. Rehman, Nisar and Shakeel were paraded before the media and then whisked away for a police interrogation. INDIA TODAY's Mihir Srivastava managed to talk to the trio exclusively. Here is his first person account.

BOMBERS

“If Allah wants, I'll bomb the market where my mother buys vegetables. She will be sent to paradise.”

ZIA-UR REHMAN